

Install Personal Finance in your own Salesforce org

A step-by-step guide to putting this multi-currency finance tracker in a free Salesforce Trailhead Playground or Developer Edition org, from scratch. You don't need any Salesforce development experience.

~20 minutes

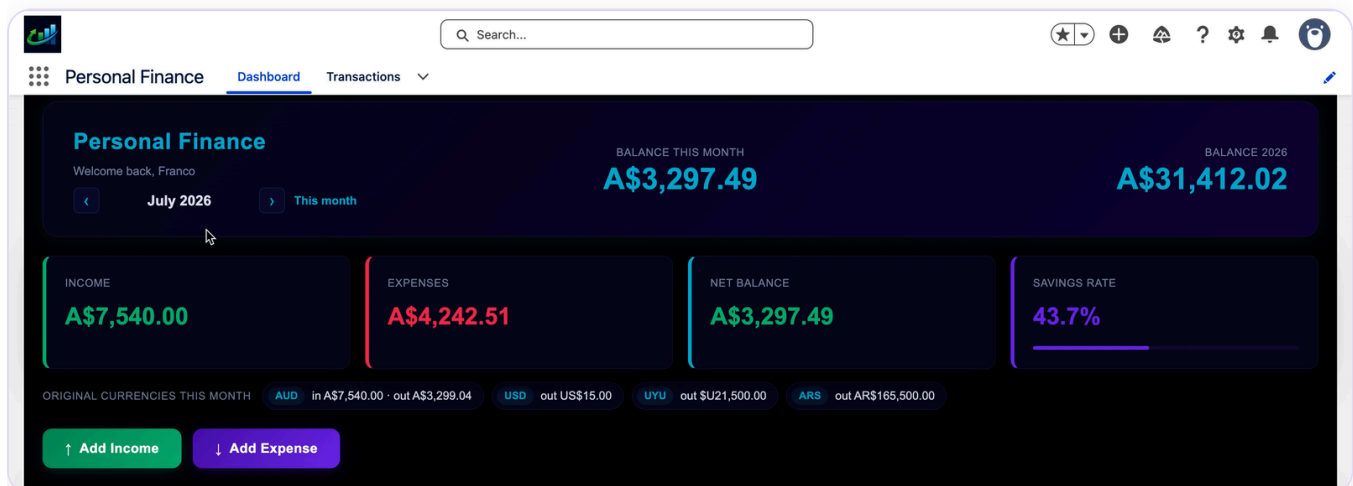
start to finish

Free

every tool used here costs nothing

Mac or Windows

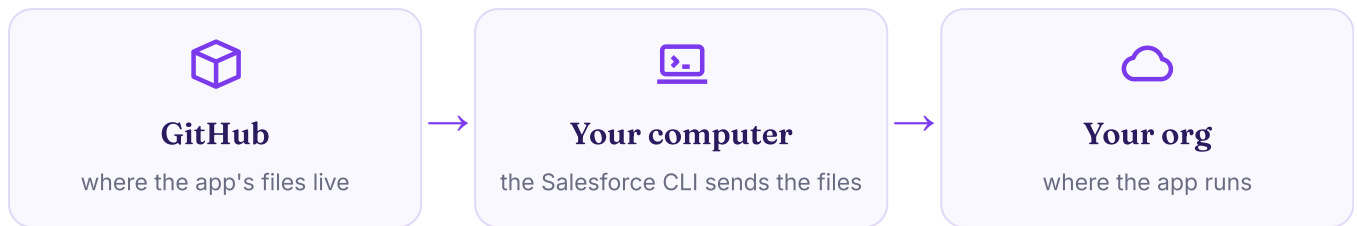
the commands are the same



What you'll have at the end: the dashboard running in your org (shown with the optional sample data).

How it works

The app is a set of files on GitHub. You download them to your computer, then a free tool called the **Salesforce CLI** sends them to your Salesforce org. That's it: no coding and no clicking through Setup.



Before you start

- ☐ **A Salesforce org to install into.** Use a **Trailhead Playground** (create one at trailhead.salesforce.com from any hands-on challenge) or a free **Developer Edition** org (developer.salesforce.com/signup).
- ☐ **That org's username and password.** Step 4 explains how to find them for a Playground.
- ☐ **About 20 minutes** and an internet connection.

Use a practice org, not a real business org

Install this in a Playground or Developer Edition org. The app adds its own objects, pages and code. The optional sample data is meant for empty orgs only.

Amounts are reported in Australian dollars

You can enter a transaction in AUD, USD, UYU or ARS. The app converts it to AUD with a live exchange rate, which needs an internet connection. The connection it uses is set up for you during the install.

The steps at a glance

#	STEP	WHAT YOU DO
1	Install the Salesforce CLI	Download and run an installer
2	Download the app	Download a ZIP file from GitHub and unzip it
3	Open a terminal in the app's folder	One small trick, shown for Mac and Windows
4	Connect your org	Log in once through your browser
5	Deploy the app	One command
6	Give yourself access	One command
7	Load sample data OPTIONAL	One command
8	Open the app	One command, then the App Launcher

1 Install the Salesforce CLI

The Salesforce CLI is the free, official tool that sends the app to your org.

1. Go to developer.salesforce.com/tools/salesforcecli.
2. Under **Choose your operating system**, click the download for your computer.
3. Open the downloaded file and follow the installer, accepting the defaults.

Choose your operating system

macos

[Download for macOS \(Apple Silicon\)](#)

[Download for macOS \(Intel CPU\)](#)

Windows

[Download for Windows x64](#)

[Download for Windows ARM64](#)

Linux

[Download for Linux x64](#)

Which Mac download?

Click the Apple menu → **About This Mac**. If it says **Apple M1, M2, M3...**, choose *Apple Silicon*. If it says **Intel**, choose *Intel CPU*.

Check that it worked

Open a terminal: on Mac, open the **Terminal** app (search for it with ⌘ + Space). On Windows, open **PowerShell** from the Start menu. Then type this and press **Enter**:

TYPE `sf --version`

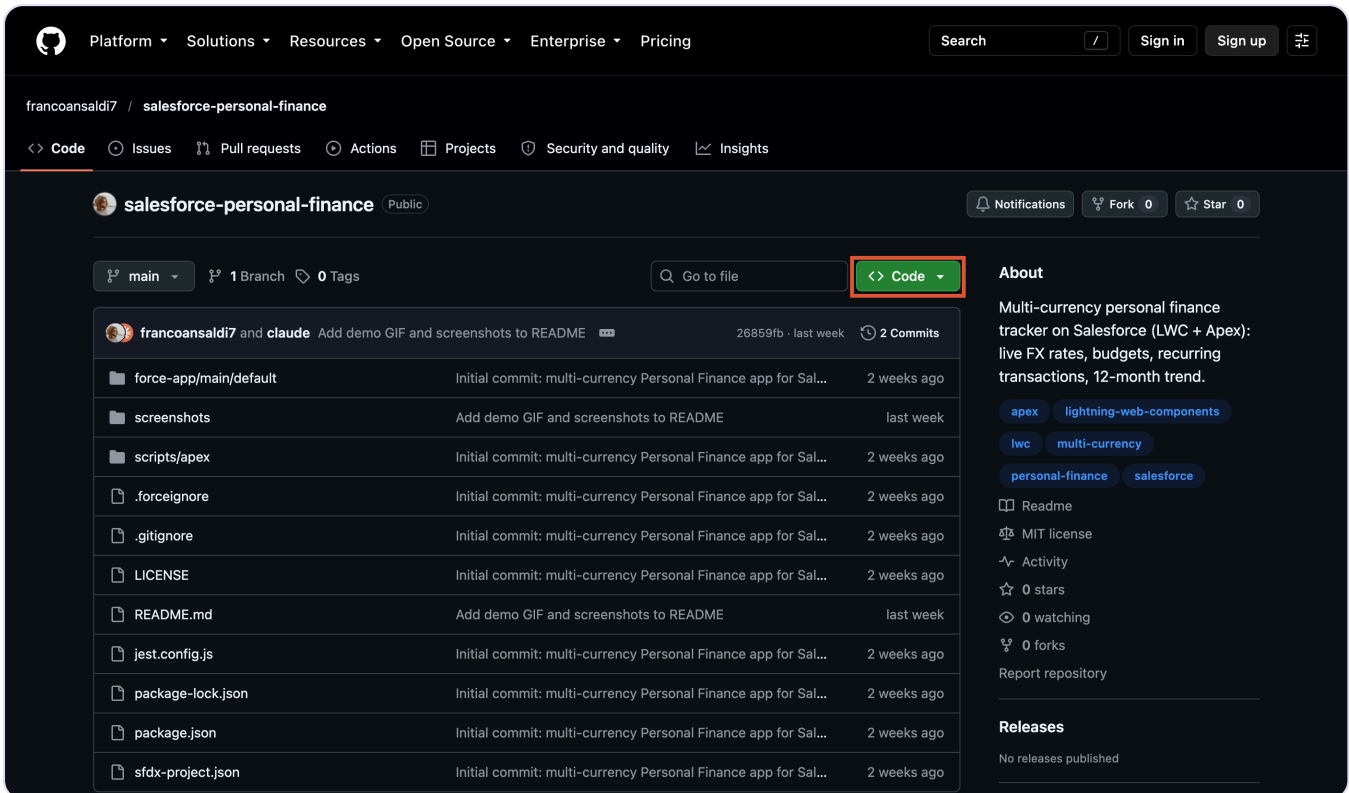
You should see a version number, similar to this:

```
Terminal
$ sf --version
@salesforce/cli/2.150.6 darwin-x64 node-v24.15.0
```

Your numbers will be different, and that's fine. If you see *command not found*, close the terminal, open a new one and try again.

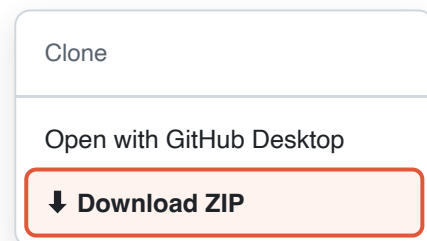
2 Download the app

1. Go to github.com/francoansaldi7/salesforce-personal-finance.
2. Click the green **Code** button.



3. In the menu that opens, click **Download ZIP**.
4. Unzip the file:
 - **Mac:** double-click it in Downloads. Safari often unzips it for you.
 - **Windows:** right-click it → **Extract All...** → **Extract**.

You now have a folder called `salesforce-personal-finance-main`.



Simplified sketch of the menu

How to know you have the right folder

Open it. You should see a folder named `force-app` and a file named `sfdx-project.json`. On Windows, the unzipped folder sometimes contains *another* folder with the same name. If so, go inside it until you see `force-app`.

Know Git? You can run `git clone https://github.com/francoansaldi7/salesforce-personal-finance.git` instead.

3 Open a terminal in the app's folder

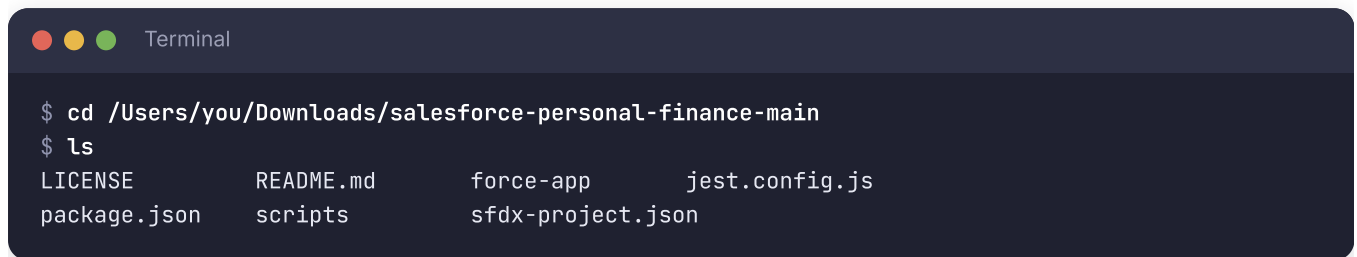
The commands in the next steps must run **inside** the app's folder (the one with `force-app` in it).

On Mac

1. Open **Terminal**.
2. Type `cd` followed by a **space**. Don't press Enter yet.
3. Drag the folder from Finder onto the Terminal window. Its location appears after `cd`.
4. Press **Enter**.

On Windows

1. Open the folder in File Explorer.
2. Click the address bar at the top, type `powershell` and press **Enter**. A PowerShell window opens, already in that folder.



```
$ cd /Users/you/Downloads/salesforce-personal-finance-main
$ ls
LICENSE      README.md    force-app    jest.config.js
package.json scripts      sfdx-project.json
```

Optional check: type `ls` (Mac) or `dir` (Windows) and press Enter. If you see `force-app` in the list, you're in the right place.

4 Connect your org

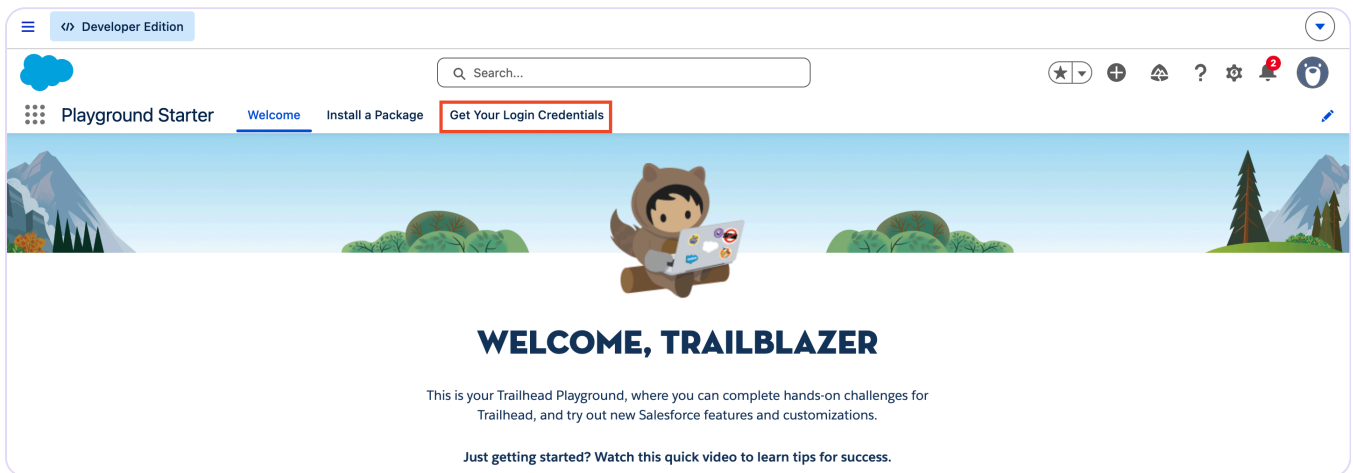
This tells the CLI which org to install into. You only do it once.

First, get your login details

Developer Edition org: use the username and password you chose when you signed up. Your username looks like an email address, but it isn't always your real email.

Trailhead Playground: Playgrounds don't show you a password, so you need to get one:

1. Open your Playground from Trailhead (**Launch** on any hands-on challenge).
2. Click the **App Launcher** (the 9-dot grid, top left), search for **Playground Starter** and open it.
3. Open the **Get Your Login Credentials** tab. Copy your **username**, then click **Reset My Password** and set a password from the email you receive.

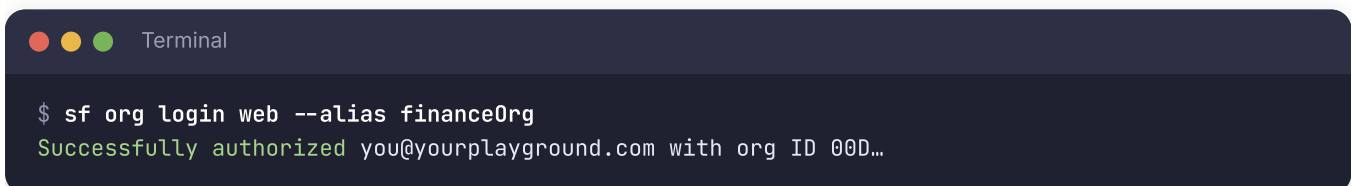


Then connect

In your terminal (still in the app's folder), type:

```
TYPE sf org login web --alias finance0rg
```

1. Your browser opens a Salesforce login page. Log in with the username and password from above.
2. If Salesforce asks you to **Allow** access, click **Allow**.
3. Go back to the terminal. You'll see a success message:



What is `--alias finance0rg` ?

It's a nickname for your org, so you don't have to type the long username in every command. The rest of this guide uses `finance0rg`.

5 Deploy the app

This sends every part of the app to your org: the objects, the dashboard, the components, the exchange-rate connection and the tests. Type:

```
TYPE sf project deploy start --source-dir force-app --target-org financeOrg
```

Wait about 30 seconds to a minute. When it finishes, you'll see **Status: Succeeded** followed by a list of the 44 parts that were created:

```
Terminal
$ sf project deploy start --source-dir force-app --target-org financeOrg

————— Deploying Metadata —————

✓ Preparing
✓ Waiting for the org to respond
✓ Deploying Metadata
  ▶ Components: 44/44 (100%)
✓ Done

Status: Succeeded
Target Org: you@yourplayground.com

Deployed Source
State   Name                Type
Created FinanceController    ApexClass
Created Personal_Finance CustomApplication
Created ExchangeRate_API RemoteSiteSetting
...     (44 components in total)
```

If you see *Failed* instead, check the Troubleshooting page at the end of this guide.

6 Give yourself access

Salesforce hides new apps until a user is given permission. The app includes a **permission set** (a bundle of permissions) called `Finance_Full_Access`. Assign it to yourself:

```
TYPE sf org assign permset --name Finance_Full_Access --target-org financeOrg
```

```
Terminal
$ sf org assign permset --name Finance_Full_Access --target-org financeOrg
Permsets Assigned
Username                Permission Set Assignment
you@yourplayground.com  Finance_Full_Access
```

This gives you the app, its tabs, and access to your own transactions and budgets.

7 Load sample data OPTIONAL

An empty dashboard is hard to explore. This step fills it with **made-up** data so every chart has something to show: about nine months of salary, rent, groceries and subscriptions ending this month, some income in US dollars, a trip paid in Uruguayan and Argentine pesos, two planned expenses and seven budgets.

```
TYPE sf apex run --file scripts/apex/seed-sample-data.apex --target-org financeOrg
```



```
Terminal

$ sf apex run --file scripts/apex/seed-sample-data.apex --target-org financeOrg
Compiled successfully.
Executed successfully.

""
USER_DEBUG[[192]]|DEBUG|Sample data loaded: 238 transactions, ...
```

After *Executed successfully* the terminal prints a long technical log. You can ignore it. The line near the end, *"Sample data loaded"*, confirms it worked. Your numbers will differ, because the dates are relative to today.

Built-in safety check

The script only runs in an org with **no transactions yet**. If you run it twice, or in an org that already has your own records, it stops and changes nothing:



```
Terminal

Error (executeRuntimeFailure): Execution failed at this code:
SeedSafetyException: This org already has 238 transactions: sample data is only
loaded into an empty org. Nothing was changed.
```

8 Open the app

```
TYPE sf org open --target-org financeOrg
```

Your org opens in the browser, already logged in. Then:

1. Click the **App Launcher** (the 9-dot grid, top left).
2. Type **Personal Finance** in the search box.
3. Under **Apps**, click **Personal Finance**.
4. Click the **Dashboard** tab, the first one in the navigation bar, to see the dashboard shown on the cover.

Don't see the app? Refresh the page once. More help is on the [Troubleshooting](#) page.

Things to try

WHAT	HOW
Add a transaction	Click <i>+ New transaction</i> . Pick <i>USD</i> as the currency and watch the live exchange rate fill in.
Budgets	Set a monthly limit per category. The bar turns amber at 80% and red when you go over.
Recurring	Create a weekly, fortnightly or monthly transaction, such as rent or salary.
Trend chart	Hover any bar to see that month's income or expenses.
Search and filter	Search descriptions, or filter the list by type and category.
Undo delete	Delete a transaction and use the 5-second <i>Undo</i> to bring it back.
Other months	Use the arrows to move between months, including up to 12 months ahead for planned transactions.

+ Run the tests OPTIONAL

Want to confirm everything works in your org? The app includes automated Apex tests. This takes a minute or two:

```
TYPE sf apex run test --class-names FinanceControllerTest --code-coverage --  
result-format human --target-org financeOrg
```

Look for **Outcome: Passed** and **Pass Rate: 100%** in the summary at the end.

Troubleshooting

YOU SEE...

WHAT TO DO

<code>command not found: sf</code> or <i>'sf' is not recognized</i>	The CLI isn't installed yet, or the terminal was open during the install. Close the terminal, open a new one and try again. If it still fails, reinstall (step 1).
<i>No authorization information found for financeOrg</i>	The org isn't connected yet, or the alias is spelled differently. Repeat step 4 and use exactly <code>--alias financeOrg</code> .
<i>This directory does not contain a valid Salesforce DX project</i>	The terminal isn't in the app's folder. Repeat step 3 and make sure you can see <code>force-app</code> in that folder.
The browser login in step 4 says your password is wrong	For a Playground, reset the password from <i>Playground Starter</i> (step 4). Check that you're using the username , not your email address.
Step 5 says <i>Failed</i>	Read the error lines in the table it prints. The most common cause is installing into an org that already has a different app with the same object names. Use a fresh Playground.
<i>Duplicate PermissionSetAssignment</i> in step 6	Nothing to fix: the permission set is already assigned to you.
<i>SeedSafetyException</i> in step 7	Expected if the org already has transactions. The sample data only loads into an empty org, and nothing was changed.
The app isn't in the App Launcher	Refresh the page. Salesforce sometimes takes a moment to show a newly assigned app. If it's still missing, repeat step 6.
The exchange rate doesn't fill in for a foreign currency	The live rate needs an internet connection and the rate service to be reachable. You can always type the rate yourself: the field is editable.

Words used in this guide

Org	Your own Salesforce environment, with its own data, users and apps.
Trailhead Playground	A free practice org that Trailhead creates for you.
Salesforce CLI	The official command-line tool for working with orgs. <code>sf</code> is its command.
Terminal	The window where you type commands: <i>Terminal</i> on Mac, <i>PowerShell</i> on Windows.
Deploy	To send the app's files from your computer to your org.
Permission set	A bundle of permissions you assign to a user to give access to an app.
Alias	A short nickname for an org, used in commands instead of its username.

That's it

You now have Personal Finance running in your own org. To learn how it's built (its components, security model and design decisions), read the **README** on GitHub.